



Chloe Cho <ccho@science-corps.org>

New Entry: Apply to Become a Science Corps Fellow

Science Corps <eduversumdev@gmail.com>

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To: ccho@science-corps.org

Name

Julie Walker

Emailjulie.walker@ufl.edu**Gender**

Female

City, state, and country of residence

Gainesville

Nationality

United States

When did or will you finish your PhD?

August 2021

University Education

PhD, Interdisciplinary Ecology, University of Florida 2021

BA, Biology, St. Mary's College of Maryland 2013

What are your reasons for applying to be a Science Corps fellow?

Growing up I always imagined being a great scientist, but often questioned what that meant. Within the paradigm of traditional academia, the answer to this question is often the quantity of publications or the quality of the journals which they have been accepted. However, these metrics often miss the mark. The purpose of science; to increase the understanding of the universe and the way we live in it, is only achieved if science is shared. Because of this I believe the measure of a good scientist should be how well they disseminate knowledge to effect greater change. I believe that participating in the Science Corps, would help me towards my goal of being a great scientist, by giving me the skills to translate the scientific knowledge that I have obtained within my studies to a broader audience. I believe that this

program would allow me to gain the skills needed to make my research accessible to a greater audience.

In addition to your studies, describe any relevant experiences that have prepared you for a Science Corps fellowship.

Seeing science communication as one of the greatest tools to bridge the gap between science and public, I have participated in multiple workshops and trainings to hone these skills, including participating in the National Science Policy Network Science Communications and Policy Retreat, the SciComm 2020 writeathon, several programs lead by the Florida Museum as well as Florida Seagrant classes focused on the intersection of science, policy, and the public. I have also taken every opportunity to present my research to multiple audiences ranging from peers, to resource managers, and the public. I have worked on my written communication skills through the publication of my research in scientific journals, managing and writing for multiple science blogs, and writing science policy memos to state lawmakers.

I also have experience working with and managing people from multiple backgrounds. As a staffer for the Chesapeake Bay Program, I was responsible for coordinating scientist from multiple universities, state natural resource agencies, and NGOs around the development of and tracking progress towards watershed level management plans. As a doctoral student I was also responsible for mentoring undergraduate students from traditionally under-represented groups in the field and helped them to develop their own research interests as a Doris Duke graduate student mentor. I also participated in the UF Multidisciplinary Research Experiences for Teachers (MRET) as an instructor where I taught elementary school teachers about what it is like to do fieldwork and helped to translate that experience into a science lesson for their students. I believe these skills would make me a good candidate for this position which requires making connections with students from diverse backgrounds.

Where do you imagine yourself professionally in the future? Check all that apply.

Academic scientist in academia
In science outreach

Expand on your selection above and describe where you imagine yourself professionally in the near (two year) and long-term (ten year) future.

As an early career scientist, it is easy to get stuck within the silos that we are often put. However, this cannot be the role of scientist in the modern world. The pressing scientific challenges of our time, such as climate change, global health, food, and water security, are not just challenges to the scientific community but to the entire planet. The scope of these problems makes it necessary for scientist to step out of their silos to make an impact. With this in mind my long term goal would be to work within the applied science or science extension realm to work with communities to adapt to effects the changing climate with have on our coastal ecosystems. In the short term I hope to gain the skills that will better prepare me for these types of careers, such as building my experience working with communities and in extension positions.

CV/Resume

 [Julie.Walker_CV_2021.pdf](#)

How did you find out about Science Corps?

University email list

7/4/2021

Science-corps Mail - New Entry: Apply to Become a Science Corps Fellow

Sent from Science Corps